

Bytes, memorable shoots and unforgettable office legends

January doesn't ease you in. It throws open the doors, turns on the lights, and asks who's ready to run.

Madhav and Mantesh joined the editorial team this month, stepping straight into the peculiar rhythm of Digit life – where curiosity is currency and no one ever quite explains things before they happen. For Madhav, the learning curve arrived fast and loud. He'd always seen journalists sprinting after famous people, microphones extended, hoping for a fleeting moment of usable wisdom – what he now knows is called a “byte.” January gave him that first taste of the press scrum, the chaos, the choreography of cameras and questions. The kind of experience that flips a switch and makes you want to get better at it, not back away.

Mid-month brought one of those moments that quietly defines a team. A message popped up: “Video Premiere at 4.” No explanation, no hype. Everyone gathered around for the Rann of Kutch video, watching patiently as it unfolded.



The entire team spellbound while watching the Rann of Kutch video!

And then came the recreation sequence. The room broke into applause – not the polite kind, but the spontaneous, slightly emotional kind. Roshni and Priyanka would later say that was the moment it hit them: this wasn't just a project. It was proof of what happens when a group of people believe in the same idea and show up for it, fully.

For Apurva, that idea had roots stretching back decades. In the early 2000s, studying cinema at Ithaca College, Lawrence of Arabia rewired something in his brain – specifically, that legendary Omar Sharif entry shot. A figure emerging from heat and nothingness, filmed in 1962 with patience, conviction, and a custom Panavision lens. The shoot was demanding, the retakes relentless, but the result – and the response – made it worth every mile.

Not all January stories were cinematic. Siddharth Malhotra spent a week unknowingly separated from his jacket, only to be confronted by his mother with the devastating question: “Where is your jacket?” The realisation

that it might be sitting patiently on his office table landed a full week late. Office desks, it turns out, have better memories than we do.

Vyom, meanwhile, became January's unofficial soundtrack. He spent the month coughing rhythmically at his desk, attempting to pass as a functional human while powering through medicines and alarming quantities of tea. The upside? Fewer interruptions. Respectful distance has its perks, even when earned through illness.

And the month closed on a quieter, heavier note. Ravi's last day came after eight and a half years at Digit – years in which he held the fort, adapted, grew, and showed up with sincerity, especially over the past 18 months. January welcomed new beginnings, but it also reminded us that goodbyes are part of the story.

That's how the year began. New voices, shared pride, lingering coughs, lost jackets, and one chapter closing as others opened. January didn't whisper. It announced itself with a bang. **d**



Case solved: Jacket found